

MOBILE WATCH

iPhone 8 & 8 Plus

The September 12 Apple Special Event was really no secret. It was held at the all-new Steve Jobs Theatre, and started off with a touching tribute to Jobs. It was the only bit that hadn't leaked before the event already. Still, it was the most significant launch of the whole month, and thus we're dedicating our mobile watch segment totally to Apple – for a change.

Both the iPhone 8 and 8 Plus will come in three colours (Gold, Silver and Space Grey), and both will have 64 and 256 GB options (as opposed to 32 and 128 GB options with the 7 and 7 Plus). There really isn't too much difference between the existing iPhone 7 and 7 Plus models in terms of dimensions and size, etc.

There really isn't too much different in terms of specs either, so we'll focus only on the differences. For starters, the biggest change is the wireless charging addon, which honestly should have come years ago. In terms of CPUs, the 8 series will feature what Apple calls the new A11 Bionic



CPU and an Apple built GPU specifically meant for Metal 2 goodness. The new A11 CPU is between 20% and 25% faster than the A10, and is actually faster in some benchmarks than Macbook CPUs! They're also over twice as fast in Geekbench 4's single core performance test than the Samsung Galaxy S8 series. Of course Synthetic benchmarks aren't everything, but anyone who has owned a brand new iPhone will tell you that they're snappy little things.

Overall, though, the iPhone 8 and 8 Plus are still too similar to the iPhone 7 series to warrant an upgrade. In fact, many feel these phones should have been called the iPhone 7s and iPhone 7s Plus.



iPhone X

ONE MORE THING... This is what everyone was waiting for, and whether you like Apple or not, it's perhaps the most significant phone launch of the year – and it hasn't even launched yet, it's only been announced! The iPhone X is a very Samsung S8 Plus looking device – in the sense of it being bezel-less and having curved glass edges. It's definitely a unique looking

phone because of the notch in the display on the top, for better or worse. It does away with TouchID and introduces FaceID – something we're still buying into, to be honest. Along with wireless charging, the iPhone X does away with the home button (at last!), and features swipe controls for multi-tasking. It's a big move away from all that's been considered iPhone so far, and in our opinion is better, but it remains to be seen how the masses react to it. We'll reserve judgement for the review when it's released. Just remember that the "X" is pronounced as "Ten", or people will jump to correct you.

EXPECTED SPECIFICATIONS

► 143.6 x 70.9 x 7.7 mm | ► 174 g | ► 5.8-inch Super AMOLED display | ► 1125 x 2436 pixels (458 ppi) | ► A11 Bionic Hexacore CPU | ► 3 GB RAM (expected) | ► 64/256 GB storage | ► IP67 weatherproofing | ► Dual 12 MP rear cameras | ► 7MP front camera | ► Fast Charging | ► Qi wireless charging | ► FaceID | ► both GSM and CDMA models | ► Bluetooth 5, NFC, 802.11ac Wi-Fi | ► iOS 11 | ► Includes EarPods with Lightning Connector